implied that the Chinese would accept the McMahon Line in the eastern region in exchange for India’s acceptance of China’s position in the western region.

During a press conference in New Delhi, this proposal was confirmed by Chou En-lai: ‘We have asked the Indian Government to adopt an attitude towards this western area similar to the attitude of the Chinese government towards the area of the eastern sector; that is, it may keep its own stand, while agreeing to conduct negotiations and not to cross the line of China’s administrative jurisdiction as shown on Chinese maps.’ This was perhaps the closest the two sides had ever come to an agreement. As is well known, this was not acceptable to Prime Minister Nehru and the Indian government. The boundary issue has continued to sour relations between the two countries.